Lundiyani Grammar Reference

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Overview and principles

Lundiyani is the modern form of Lunde: an isolating lingua franca spoken across the conworld, much later than Old Lundian and very different from it.

- **History.** Many peoples speak it, so it has dialect and register doublets, borrowings, and changes from Old Lundian that aren't always regular. The imperfection is intended.
- **Type.** Verbs never change form. Tense, aspect, mood and negation are separate particles. The only grammatical suffixes are possessive -de and the plurals -i, -en and -nen.
- **Etymology.** Most modern words have no worked-out etymology, and none is needed.
- **Working method.** New forms are checked against the rules below. Only contradictions with a stated rule and real ambiguities get flagged.
- **Sounds.** There is no h sound; Old h is lost (Old hara → ara). x is a different sound.

The full word list is in the Lexicon tab: Lexicon

Pronouns and possession

Pronouns have one form for subject and object; possessives add -de.

Person	Pronoun	Possessive
1st singular	i	ide (my)
2nd singular	o	ode (your)
3rd singular, animate	a	ade (his, her)
3rd singular, inanimate	ne	nede (its)
1st plural	ilie	iliede (our)
2nd plural	ole	olede (your)
3rd plural, animate	ale	alede (their)

Person	Pronoun	Possessive
3rd plural, inanimate	nilie	niliede (their)

- -de attaches to any word, nouns included: i onde osili (the person's eyes).
- -de is a remnant of the Old Lundian genitive (kide, ude, dade).
- Each other: on-a-oni. ale lau on-a-oni (they love each other).
- Reflexive: amon. a lo kanxi amon (she looked at herself).

Word order

The basic order is subject, verb, object, and modifiers come before what they modify.

- **Before the noun:** articles, demonstratives, possessors and adjectives. nei kawe on (this tall person), ide kora (my cat).
- **Before the verb:** negation and every tense, aspect or mood particle.
- **After the noun:** relative clauses. i on xaon lo lai yada (the person who was singing).
- **At the end:** the question particle me.
- **Prepositions** are separate words. No word attaches to another except the suffix -de and the plural endings.
- **Exceptions:** ta (to have) and commands put the verb before the subject.

Preposition	Meaning	Example
nai	in, at, on	nai ci louba (in the bottle)
an	to, towards	an ci pay (to the village)
de	from, of	de ci kala (from the sea)
am	with	am ide kiwuru (with my dog)
amb	by (the agent)	amb ni wakti (by the warriors)
on	for	on o (for you)
ewa	about	ewa o (about you)
anta	before	anta o lo luran (before you came)

Verbs and particles

Verbs never change form; tense, aspect, mood and negation are separate particles between the subject and the verb, and they combine freely.

Subject	Aspect	Negation	Tense or mood	lai, dei	Verb	Object	End
i	tefri, talei, mai, kiena	lan	lo, na, lei	lai, dei	vera	ne	me

Particle	Meaning	Example
(none)	present	i vera ne (I do it)
lo	past	i lo lau o (I loved you)
na	future	i na lau o (I will love you)
lai + verb	progressive	i lo lai vera ne (I was doing it)
dei + verb	passive	ci pay lo dei raxavi (the village was destroyed)
tefri	perfect	i tefri lo eden (I have eaten)
tefri lo lai	past perfect	i tefri lo lai eden (I had eaten)
talei	habitual, "used to"	i talei lo yada (I used to sing)
mai	just now	ilie mai lo eden (we just ate)
kiena	not yet, with lan	ale kiena lan lo eden (they haven't eaten yet)
lei	conditional	as o lei luran, i lei lai kuali (if you came, I would be happy)
lan	negation	i lan lo lai valia (I wasn't sleeping)

- lai is also the copula (i lo lai kili, I was young) and, at the start of a sentence, means "there is": lai anei nai ci louba (there is water in the bottle); negated, lan lai anei (there's no water).
- lan comes after kiena and tefri, which work like adverbs: ale kiena lan lo eden (they haven't eaten yet).
- A modal or second verb takes the bare verb: i lan sa valia (I can't sleep), ilie mail kapa (we need to talk).

- **Passive:** tense + dei + verb, with amb for the agent. ci pay lo dei raxavi amb ni wakti (the village was destroyed by the warriors); i lo dei fastixi (I was blinded). dei comes from Old daze (by him or her), the agent in the Old passive of be + participle + ablative.

ta (to have)

ta is the one verb that comes before its subject; particles and the object follow in the normal order.

Lundiyani	Meaning
ta i kora	I have a cat
ta i lo kora	I had a cat
ta i lan kora	I don't have a cat
ta o kora me?	Do you have a cat?
ta nei kawe on ra kiwuri	This tall person has two dogs

Nouns, articles and numbers

Plural nouns take -i, articles come from Old Lundian, and the numbers are the Old Lundian ones, unchanged.

- **Plural -i:** osil → osili (eyes), kiwuru → kiwuri (dogs), kora → kori (cats), on → oni (people). Inanimate nouns take -en after a consonant and -nen after a vowel: skin → skinen (books), louba → loubanen (bottles). Irregular: yami → yamo (feet). After any number above one the noun is plural: ra kiwuri (two dogs).
- **Articles:** the Old Lundian set without its accents (table below). Many speakers also use i with inanimate nouns.

Article	Animate	Inanimate	Plural
the	i	ci	ni
a, some	ia	an	na

an (a) and an (to) share one form; context tells them apart.

- **Adjectives after lai:** -de marks a permanent quality such as color or size, and only in a plain "X is ADJ" sentence: i onde osili lai lasode (the person's eyes are blue). It never appears before a noun (ko kiwuru, a big dog) or in comparisons. Without -de the word names a state or an impression: i lai kuali, literally "I am happiness" (kuali = happy, happiness).
- **Comparison:** kaw + adjective + da. i wuru lai kaw ko da i kiwuru (the wolf is bigger than the dog).
- **Superlative:** i kaw + adjective. a lai i kaw leia on nai ci payi'an (she is the most beautiful person in the city).

Numbers count in base twelve, as in Old Lundian. Before a noun the bare form is used; when counting, é- goes in front (é-na, é-ra).

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
na	ra	ara	du	jayu	java	isa	gvena	fisa	dion	fiú	sión

Powers of twelve: sión (12), igyión (144), galatión (1,728), ayatión (20,736). Numbers are built as in Old Lundian: rasión (24), sión-na (13). The list's re (two) is outdated.

Questions

Yes/no questions end in me; question words stay where the answer would go, or move to the front.

- o lo vera ne me? (Did you do it?)
- o lai vera xa? or xa o lai vera? (What are you doing?) In place is more grammatical; both are common.
- xaon lau o? (Who loves you?) A subject question word is already in place at the start.
- Questions with a question word take no me.

Word	Meaning
xa	what
xaon	who
maxa	where
xar	when (also: near)

Word	Meaning
anxa	why
axla	how
xataw	how many, how much
xati	what kind

Clauses and commands

Subordinate clauses open with a conjunction; relative clauses use sa after the noun; commands are ov + verb + person.

- **and:** a before a consonant, ad before a vowel. ide kora ad ode kiwuru (my cat and your dog).
- **when:** xanarya after the main clause: a lo lai yada xanarya o lo luran (she was singing when you came). When the when-clause comes first, xar, though xanarya also works: xar i lo lai kili, i talei lo yada (when I was young, I used to sing).
- **if:** as, with lei in both clauses. as o lei luran, i lei lai kuali (if you came, I would be happy).
- **Other conjunctions:** ema (because), ant (but), anta (before), nes (until), dal or ana (while), no (or).
- **Relative clauses:** noun + sa + clause, as in Old Lundian, for people and things: i on sa yada lai ide bana (the person who sings is my brother). ci skin sa o lo sila lai leia (the book that you wrote is beautiful). xaon is also used for people: i on xaon lo lai yada lai kuali (the person who was singing is happy).
- **That-clauses:** xa. i so xa o na luran (I know that you will come).

Command	Meaning
ov lua	go! (formally ov lua o)
ov lua ilie	let's go
ov lua a	let him or her go
ov lua ale	let them go

The person comes after the verb. With singular you it has fallen out of use (ov eden, eat!), but formal writing keeps it (ov eden o). Negation follows ov: ov lan lua ilie (let's not go). ov keeps commands apart from o (you).

Word formation

A few productive suffixes build new words; unlike the particles, they are part of the word.

Pattern	Meaning	Examples
plain verb	experiencing	kana (see), kawa (hear), ampa (feel)
-xi	doing it actively or on purpose	kanxi (look), kawxi (listen), ampxi (touch)
-kai	making someone do it	edenkai (feed), enakai (explain), iloarikai (make cry); works on any verb
-on	person	yadaon (singer), kiliyon (child)
-li	thing	kaxli (name), sipli (end)
xle-	undoing	xlera (forget), from lera (remember)

nia (to make someone feel an emotion) is a separate verb, never a suffix: it can make someone sad, but not make them cry: o lo nia i drese (you made me sad).

The indefinite words form a grid:

	any	every	some	no
person	avon	elion	naon	lanon
thing	avali	eleili	li	lani
place	avama	eleima	nama	lanma
time	avaya (forever)	evai (always)	na-a-nari (sometimes)	levai (never)

Vocabulary decisions

These were settled on 2026-10-14 and override the master vocabulary list.

Word	Decision
keme, kemxi	smell, sniff (were kemekeme, kemxikemxi)
ini	here (was ina)
nama	somewhere (was naoma)
xar	when? and near; xanarya is the conjunction "when"
o, ole	you (singular), you (plural)
ta	to have; ave is dropped
kime	short; size words to revisit
urane	to harm
erane	to kill, from the Old namon irrana (irrasa, to grab)
mana	spiritual energy; lawmana = to marry
na, ra, ara…	numbers are the Old Lundian ones; re is outdated
lurankai	to move someone; -kai and -xi are part of the word
ov	command particle; replaces o so commands don't look like "you"
ara	three; Lundiyani has no h (Old hara)
dei	passive particle
amon	reflexive: herself, himself, itself
adar, idar	to leave, to arrive; idari is outdated
malai	parent (in general); family and animal words vary by region and all stay

Word	Decision
lala, lurani, tu'ali, taluv, tavnei, vantasi, xwitiwi, nivya	the spaces in the master list were typos

- Doublets (resa and akaxl, kaxi and kaxli, dal and ana…) are deliberate dialect or register variants.
- au and aw spell the same sound.
- Final a → ai happened in some words only; it is not a rule.
- Karen is not a word; a → al is not a rule.

Example sentences

The first elicited sentences, glossed word by word with two slips fixed (me in 9, ad in 13).

```
1. 'I have eaten.'
i    tefri  lo   eden
1SG  PRF    PST  eat

2. 'I had eaten when you came.'
i    tefri  lo   lai  eden  xanarya  o    lo   luran
1SG  PRF    PST  be   eat   when     2SG  PST  come

3. 'When I was young, I used to sing every day.'
xar   i    lo   lai  kili   i    talei  lo   yada  elei   teila
when  1SG  PST  be   young  1SG  IPFV   PST  sing  every  day

4. 'She was singing when you came.'
a    lo   lai  yada  xanarya  o    lo   luran
3SG  PST  be   sing  when     2SG  PST  come

5. 'We just ate.'
ilie  mai  lo   eden
1PL   REC  PST  eat

6. 'They haven't eaten yet.'
ale  kiena  lan  lo   eden
3PL  YET    NEG  PST  eat

7. 'If you came, I would be happy.'
as  o    lei   luran,  i    lei   lai  kuali
```

```
if  2SG  COND  come    1SG  COND  be   happy
```

8. 'I wasn't sleeping.'

```
i    lan  lo   lai  valia
1SG  NEG  PST  be   sleep
```

9. 'Did you have a dog?'

```
ta    o    lo   ia    kiwuru  me
have  2SG  PST  INDF  dog     Q
```

10. 'My cat and your dog are small.'

```
i-de      kora  ad   o-de      kiwuru  lai  ki-de
1SG-POSS  cat   and  2SG-POSS  dog     be   small-DE
```

11. 'The person's eyes are blue.'

```
i    on-de        osil-i  lai  laso-de
DEF  person-POSS  eye-PL  be   blue-DE
```

12. 'This tall person has two dogs.'

```
ta    nei   kawe  on      ra   kiwur-i
have  this  tall  person  two  dog-PL
```

13. 'I saw a cat, and the cat saw me.'

```
i    lo   kana  ia    kora,  ad   i    kora  lo   kana  i
1SG  PST  see   INDF  cat    and  DEF  cat   PST  see   1SG
```

14. 'Who loves you?'

```
xaon  lau   o
who   love  2SG
```

15. 'What are you doing?'

```
o    lai  vera  xa        xa    o    lai  vera
2SG  be   do    what      what  2SG  be   do
```

16. 'The person who was singing is happy.'

```
i    on      xaon  lo   lai  yada  lai  kuali
DEF  person  who   PST  be   sing  be   happy
```

17. 'Let's eat! Let's go!'

```
ov   eden  ilie      ov   lua  ilie
IMP  eat   1PL       IMP  go   1PL
```

Abbreviations: PRF perfect (tefri), IPFV imperfective (talei), REC just now (mai), YET not yet (kiena), COND conditional (lei), NEG lan, IMP command o, DEF and INDF the articles i and ia, POSS -de, PL plural -i.

Round 2, checked:

```
1. 'There is water in the bottle.'
lai  anei   nai  ci        louba
be   water  in   DEF.INAN  bottle

2. 'Some people came to the village.'
na       on-i       lo   luran  an  ci        pay
INDF.PL  person-PL  PST  come   to  DEF.INAN  village

3. 'I came from the sea with my dog.'
i    lo   luran  de    ci        kala  am    i-de      kiwuru
1SG  PST  come   from  DEF.INAN  sea   with  1SG-POSS  dog

4. 'The wolf is bigger than the dog.'
i    wuru  lai  kaw   ko   da    i    kiwuru
DEF  wolf  be   more  big  than  DEF  dog

5. 'She is the most beautiful person in the city.'
a    lai  i    kaw   leia       on      nai  ci        payi'an
3SG  be   DEF  more  beautiful  person  in   DEF.INAN  city

6. 'They destroyed the village.'
ale  lo   raxavi   ci        pay
3PL  PST  destroy  DEF.INAN  village

7. 'I made her cry.'
i    lo   iloari-kai  a
1SG  PST  cry-CAUS    3SG

8. 'I saw the bird, but I didn't look at it.'
i    lo   kana  i    kioto,  ant  i    lan  lo   kanxi  a
1SG  PST  see   DEF  bird    but  1SG  NEG  PST  look   3SG

9. 'Where do you live?'
o    nivya  maxa
2SG  live   where

10. 'Why didn't you come?'
```

```
o    lan  lo   luran  anxa
2SG  NEG  PST  come   why

11. 'How many cats do you have?'
ta    o    xataw     kor-i
have  2SG  how.many  cat-PL

12. 'I can't sleep because I'm sad.'
i    lan  sa   valia  ema      i    lai  drese
1SG  NEG  can  sleep  because  1SG  be   sad

13. 'I know that you will come.'
i    so    xa    o    na   luran
1SG  know  that  2SG  FUT  come

14. 'The book that you wrote is beautiful.'
ci        skin  sa   o    lo   sila   lai  leia
DEF.INAN  book  REL  2SG  PST  write  be   beautiful

15. 'We need to talk.'
ilie  mail  kapa
1PL   need  talk

16. 'They love each other.'
ale  lau   on-a-oni
3PL  love  each.other

17. 'I have twenty-five dogs.'
ta    i    rasión-na    kiwur-i
have  1SG  twenty-five  dog-PL
```

New abbreviations: INDF.PL na (some), CAUS -kai, REL sa. Sentence 6 is the active version; the passive is still being settled.

Round 3, checked:

```
1. 'The village was destroyed by the warriors.'
ci        pay      lo   dei   raxavi   amb  ni      wakti
DEF.INAN  village  PST  PASS  destroy  by   DEF.PL  warrior

2. 'I was blinded.'
i    lo   dei   fastixi
1SG  PST  PASS  blind
```

```
3. 'I bought two bottles and three books.'
i    lo   dail  ra   louba-nen  ad   ara    skin-en
1SG  PST  buy   two  bottle-PL  and  three  book-PL

4. 'The person who sings is my brother.'
i    on      sa   yada  lai  i-de      bana
DEF  person  REL  sing  be   1SG-POSS  brother

5. 'You made me sad.'
o    lo   nia   i    drese
2SG  PST  make  1SG  sad

6. 'The dog is big.' / 'I saw a big dog.'
i    kiwuru  lai  ko-de
DEF  dog     be   big-DE

i    lo   kana  ia    ko   kiwuru
1SG  PST  see   INDF  big  dog

7. 'Open the bottle!'
ov   kiaw  ci        louba
IMP  open  DEF.INAN  bottle

8. 'Let's not go.'
ov   lan  lua  ilie
IMP  NEG  go   1PL

9. 'There's no water.'
lan  lai  anei
NEG  be   water

10. 'Before you came, I was sad.'
anta    o    lo   luran,  i    lo   lai  drese
before  2SG  PST  come    1SG  PST  be   sad

11. 'I did it for you.'
i    lo   vera  ne        on   o
1SG  PST  do    3SG.INAN  for  2SG

12. 'We talked about you.'
ilie  lo   kapa  ewa    o
1PL   PST  talk  about  2SG
```

```
13. 'I'll wait until you come.'
i    na   dalod  nes    o    luran
1SG  FUT  wait   until  2SG  come

14. 'She looked at herself.'
a    lo   kanxi  amon
3SG  PST  look   self

15. 'The cat's eyes are green.'
i    kora-de   osil-i  lai  reiki-de
DEF  cat-POSS  eye-PL  be   green-DE
```

New abbreviations: PASS dei, DEF.PL ni. Commands in the earlier rounds now use ov.

Open questions

- [x] ~~Where does lan go next to an aspect particle? Sentence 6 has ale kiena lan lo eden, but the stated rule puts lan right after the subject.~~
- [x] ~~Sentence 2: does i tefri lo lai eden mean "had eaten" or "had been eating"? How is the other one said?~~
- [x] ~~Sentence 3 uses xar as the conjunction "when" at the start. Is xar the conjunction when the when-clause comes first?~~
- [x] ~~Sentence 9 (ta o lo ia kiwuru) has no me. Is me optional in yes/no questions?~~
- [x] ~~Sentence 13 has a i kora, but the a/ad rule gives ad before a vowel.~~
- [x] ~~-de on predicate adjectives: lai kide, lai lasode, but lai kili, lai kuali. Inherent property vs passing state?~~
- [x] ~~Articles: is the inanimate "a" an (Old án), even though an also means "to"? In the plural, does ni cover both "the" and "some", or is na still "some"?~~
- [ ] Plural rule: does -i replace a final vowel (kiwuru → kiwuri) and get added after a consonant (osil → osili)? Do inanimate nouns pluralize the same way?
- [x] ~~adar / idar or adari / idari (leave, arrive)?~~
- [ ] Still unconfirmed from the first batch: the insults (pana, lande, viade), jos (blood) and kuner (knife).
- [x] ~~Spacing in the master list: lal a, nivy a, t u' ali, talu v, tavne i, vantas i, xwit i wi.~~
- [x] ~~Passive with dei: is it tense + dei + verb, with amb for the agent (ci pay lo dei raxavi amb ni wakti)?~~

- [x] ~~Inanimate plural: when is it -ne and when -nen?~~
- [x] ~~Relative clauses for people: sa, xaon, or both?~~